

Gestational Diabetes - ADA

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Gestational Diabetes | American Diabetes Association

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Life with Diabetes Gestational Diabetes Can you have gestational diabetes and a healthy baby? Yes. Image

It can be a scary diagnosis, but it's one that's fairly common. Gestational diabetes (GDM)—diabetes diagnosed during pregnancy—affects up to 9% of pregnancies in the U.S. each year, so know you're not alone. If you are diagnosed, this doesn't mean you had diabetes before pregnancy nor does it mean you'll have it after giving birth. The key is to act swiftly, remain consistent, and stay on top of your condition. GDM is treatable, manageable, and something you can effectively manage. With your health care provider's support, you can have a healthy pregnancy and baby. What We Know About GDM The exact cause of GDM is unclear and there's a lot we don't know. But—we do know that the placenta's hormones, which support the baby's growth, can sometimes block the mother's insulin, leading to insulin resistance. This makes it harder for the body to use insulin effectively, requiring the mother to produce more. If the body can't produce enough insulin during pregnancy, glucose remains in the blood, leading to high blood glucose (blood sugar). No matter the cause, you can work with your healthcare provider to create a plan that ensures a healthy pregnancy. Don't hesitate to ask questions or seek support—there are many effective ways to manage GDM. Protecting You and Your Baby Take these steps to keep you and your baby healthy: Get screened: Early treatment helps prevent health issues for both you and your baby. The key is to act quickly so you can start managing it right away. Make a treatment plan: Early treatment helps prevent health issues for both you and your baby. Work with your healthcare team to develop a treatment plan.

GDM Treatment Taking quick action is essential. While GDM is treatable, it can pose health risks to both you and your baby if left unmanaged. The primary goal of treatment is to keep your blood glucose levels within a normal range. This may involve special meal plans, regular physical activity, daily blood glucose testing, and insulin injections. Remember, with the right approach and the support of your healthcare team, you can ensure a healthy pregnancy. Image

Healthy Eating Is Key to Success As with all forms of diabetes, diet is a crucial management tool. Your healthcare provider can help you develop a personalized meal plan that will guide you toward the best food choices and easy meal ideas that keep you healthy and strong throughout your pregnancy. An easy way to start your healthy eating journey is with the Diabetes Plate . Image

Move More to Manage Exercise plays a vital role in managing GDM. Collaborate with your healthcare provider to determine the safest level of activity for you and your baby during pregnancy. Start slow and make the movement more fun by bringing your partner, friend, or family member along with you! Image

Reduce Your Risk for Type 2 Diabetes Did you know that about 50% of women with GDM go on to develop type 2 diabetes? That doesn't have to be your story. The National Diabetes Prevention Program (National DPP) is a lifestyle change program proven to reduce the risk of developing type 2 diabetes by 58%. If you've been diagnosed with GDM, you may qualify for the National DPP.

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Women's Health Resources

Nutrition Diabetes Plate and Gestational Diabetes 4 Ways to Make Grocery Shopping Easier Reading Nutrition Labels Sample Meal Plan and Menu Ideas for Pregnancy with GDM and After Delivery

Resources Getting a Physical Exam Before Getting Pregnant Planning for Pregnancy Living with Diabetes What to Expect When You are Expecting What is Gestational Diabetes?

Infographics Glucose Monitoring During Pregnancy Gestational Diabetes and Health Equality Blood Glucose Monitoring and GDM GDM Screening Guidelines GDM Treatment GDM in Real Life Prioritize Your Health Before and Early in Pregnancy

Resources for You Check out these helpful American Diabetes Association resources: Diabetes and Pregnancy Treatment & Perspective How Gestational Diabetes Can Impact Your Baby B reastfeeding and Diabetes Professional Resources Women with a history of GDM have an increased risk for recurrent diabetes in subsequent pregnancies and a 10-fold risk of developing type 2 diabetes (compared to women without GDM). To address this growing problem, the ADA offers a free online continuing education (CE) course and supporting resources essential for care professionals on screening, treating, and monitoring GDM. [Learn More](#)

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